CHAPTER 72 North Eastern Council

Establishment

The North Eastern Council is a statutory (and not a constitutional) advisory body. It was established in the year 1972[1] through an Act of Parliament, namely the North Eastern Council Act, 1971[2].

The Council consists of eight mem-ber states of the North Eastern Region, viz. Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Sikkim and Tripura. In 2002, Sikkim became the eighth member state of the Council[3]. The Secretariat (Headquarters) of the Council is located in Shillong, Meghalaya.

The Council was set-up for securing bal-anced development of the North Eastern Region, for effecting better inter-state co-ordination, and for maintaining security and public order in the region. By virtue of the 2002 Amendment, the Council has been made the Regional Planning Body for the north eastern region.

The Council operates under the admin-istrative control of the Union Ministry of Development of the North Eastern Region (DONER).

COMPOSITION

The Council consists of the following members:

1. The Governors of the eight member states
2. The Chief Ministers of the eight mem-ber states; however, if there are no Council of Ministers in any of these eight states, then the President may nominate one person to represent that state in the Council for so long as there is no Council of Ministers in that state
3. Three members are to be nominated by the President of India to the Council
4. The President of India may, if deemed necessary, nominate a Union Minister to be a member of the Council
5. The President of India nominates the Chairman of the Council
6. The President of India may, if deemed necessary, nominate another member of the Council to act as Vice Chairman of the Council

Since July 2018, the Union Home Minister is the ex-officio Chairman and the Minister[4] (In-charge), Ministry of DONER is the ex-officio Vice-Chairman of the Council.

FUNCTIONS

The functions of the Council are as follows:

1. The Council shall function as a regional planning body for the north-eastern area.
2. While formulating the regional plans for the north-eastern area, the Coun-cil shall give priority to schemes and projects which will benefit two or more states. However, in case of Sikkim, the